CORVANE SYSTEMS

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Owner	Chief People Officer
Applies to	All employees, contractors, interns, candidates and visitors

Anti-Harassment and Equal Opportunity Policy

1. Our commitment

Everyone at Corvane has the right to work in an environment free from harassment, bullying, discrimination and victimisation. We make decisions about hiring, pay, promotion, training and dismissal on the basis of skills, performance and potential only.

This policy applies wherever work happens: in the office, when working from home, on business trips, at client sites, at company events and offsites (including the after-party), and in online channels such as Teams, email and social media when they involve colleagues.

2. Protected characteristics

Corvane does not tolerate discrimination based on any of the following: age, disability, sex, gender identity and expression, sexual orientation, pregnancy and maternity or paternity, marital or civil partnership status, race, colour, nationality, ethnic or national origin, religion or belief, political opinion, trade union membership, and part-time or fixed-term contract status.

3. Definitions

- **Direct discrimination**: treating someone less favourably because of a protected characteristic. Example: not inviting a candidate to interview because of their age.
- **Indirect discrimination**: a rule that applies to everyone but puts people with a protected characteristic at a disadvantage without good reason. Example: requiring all team meetings to start at 18:00, which disadvantages people with caring responsibilities.
- **Harassment**: unwanted behaviour related to a protected characteristic that violates someone's dignity or creates an intimidating, hostile, degrading, humiliating or offensive environment. What counts is the **effect** on the person, not the intention of the person behaving that way.
- **Sexual harassment**: unwanted conduct of a sexual nature, including comments about appearance, sexual jokes, unwanted touching, sending sexual images and repeated requests for dates after a "no".
- **Bullying**: offensive, intimidating, malicious or insulting behaviour, or an abuse of power, that undermines or humiliates someone. Bullying does not need to be linked to a protected characteristic.
- **Victimisation**: treating someone badly because they made a complaint or supported someone else's complaint.

Reasonable management instructions, honest feedback about performance and legitimate disagreement are **not** bullying, as long as they are delivered respectfully.

4. Equal opportunity in practice

- Job adverts use inclusive language and are reviewed with the Corvane inclusive-writing checker.
- Every interview panel has at least **two interviewers**, and at least one of them has completed the "Fair Hiring" training.
- Salaries are reviewed every year for unexplained gaps between groups, and the results are reported to the Executive Team.
- Corvane provides **reasonable adjustments** for employees and candidates with a disability or long-term health condition, such as adapted equipment, flexible hours or changes to the interview format. Requests go to the People Team and are handled confidentially.

5. What to do if it happens to you

You can choose the route that feels right:

1. **Informal resolution.** If you feel able to, tell the person that their behaviour is unwelcome and ask them to stop. Many situations are resolved this way. You can ask your manager or a People Partner to support you.
2. **Formal complaint.** Submit a written complaint to the People Team (people@corvane.example) or to the Ethics & Compliance Office. You can choose the formal route at any time, even without trying the informal route first.
3. **Corvane Ethics Line.** Report online or by phone, 24/7, anonymously if you prefer.

You can also talk confidentially to one of the **Corvane Confidential Advisers**, trained colleagues who listen, explain your options and help you decide. They do not investigate and they do not share what you say without your permission, except where there is an immediate risk to someone's safety.

6. How formal complaints are handled

- The People Team acknowledges the complaint and appoints an independent investigator who has no reporting relationship with the people involved. The investigation starts within **5 working days**.
- Both the person complaining and the person complained about can be accompanied at interviews by a colleague or a trade union representative.
- Corvane aims to complete the investigation within **30 calendar days**. If it will take longer, both parties are told why and given a new date.
- During the investigation, **interim measures** can be taken to protect the people involved, such as changing seating or reporting lines, or a temporary period of paid leave. Interim measures are not a punishment.
- Both parties receive the outcome in writing and can appeal within **10 working days**.

Information is shared only with people who need it to handle the complaint.

7. If you witness it: the 5 Ds of bystander action

Witnesses play a big part in stopping harassment. If it is safe, choose one of these options:

- **Direct**: speak up in the moment ("That comment is not OK.").
- **Distract**: interrupt the situation, for example by asking the targeted person to help you with something.
- **Delegate**: ask someone else for help, such as a manager, a fire warden or event security.
- **Delay**: check in with the targeted person afterwards and ask how you can support them.
- **Document**: write down what you saw, with date and time, and give the notes to the targeted person.

8. Protection and consequences

- Nobody will be treated badly for raising a complaint, supporting a colleague or giving evidence in good faith. Victimisation is a serious disciplinary offence.
- Harassment, bullying and discrimination can lead to disciplinary action up to and including dismissal. Contractors and suppliers can have their contracts terminated.
- Complaints that are knowingly false and made in bad faith are also a disciplinary matter. A complaint that is not upheld is not automatically a false complaint.

9. Training

All employees complete "Respect at Work" training within **30 days** of joining and every **2 years** after that. Managers complete an additional module on handling complaints.

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